

So let's discuss the performance numbers to get a better handle on how bearish crabs actually perform.

Statistics

[Table 19.2](#) shows general statistics for the bearish crab.

Number found. I dug up 1,566 crabs in 883 stocks using data from December 1990 to June 2019. Not all stocks covered the entire time, and some stocks no longer trade.

Breakeven failure rate. This is a count of how many patterns fail to see price drop more than 5% below the high at D. The lower the number, the better. As the table shows, and as one would expect, bear markets have less than half the failure rate of bull markets. That's because price is following the downward market trend in bear markets instead of dropping against a rising trend in bull markets.

[Table 19.2](#) General Statistics

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Number found	1,357	209
Breakeven failure rate	19.8%	8.9%
Average decline after D	−14.3%	−22.9%
Volume trend	50% Random	51% Upward
Performance Up/Down volume	−15% U, −13% D	−24% U, −22% D

Average decline after D. I measured the average decline from the peak at D to either the ultimate low (the lowest low before price climbed more than 20%) or the lowest low measured from D to where price closed above point D. Patterns in bear markets show larger declines. No surprise there.

Volume trend, performance. The volume *trend* numbers are random. However, the *performance* numbers confirm that crabs with upward volume trends (as measured using linear regression from the start of the pattern to the end, X to D) marginally outperform those with downward volume trends. I consider the performance differences to deserve a yawn.